Access and Inclusion: The Fabric of Cambridge

The role of the Cambridge Commission for Persons with Disabilities (CCPD) in making accessibility part of Cambridge's DNA

Human Services and Veterans Committee Public Hearing

March 11, 2026

CCPD Cambridge Commission for Persons with Disabilities

CCPD’s Overall Purpose

Making the City of Cambridge a welcoming and accessible place for people with all types of disabilities.

CCPD's Work: Internal

Work in partnership with employees in departments across the City, providing training, technical assistance, subject matter expertise, design review, etc. through a disability lens.

- Examples of internal work:
  - Advancing communication access
  - Providing accessible design expertise on street & sidewalk reconstruction projects
  - Currently partnering with multiple city departments to update the employee Reasonable Accommodation Policy and reporting procedures
  - Assisting colleagues in responding to requests for reasonable modifications
  - Sitting on numerous interdepartmental committees

CCPD's Work: External

- Provides information & referral services to constituents regarding disability-related inquiries
- Serves as a liaison for individuals experiencing difficulties in accessing City services
- Identifies and addresses patterns and gaps in community needs and wishes regarding disability inclusion
- Informs constituents of their rights and responsibilities under relevant disability rights-related laws and ordinances
- Investigates ADA grievances against the City

CCPD Staff Collaborations (External)

- Commissions on Disability Alliance (MA)
- Coalition of Municipal Offices for Persons with Disabilities (national)
- MA Municipal ADA Coordinators
- MA Emergency Management Agency Access and Functional Needs Advisory Committee
- Mount Auburn Hospital Community Benefits Advisory Committee
- MA Health and Disability Partnership
- MA College of Pharmacy and Health Sciences Community Advisory Board

Role of CCPD Advisory Board

- Provides feedback and input to City departments on policies, practices, and community engagement strategies
- Engages in special projects to make the City of Cambridge more welcoming and inclusive for people with disabilities
- Keeps CCPD staff apprised on community needs regarding people with disabilities
- Assists staff with community outreach at events

CCPD Moves to the Equity & Inclusion Dept.

- Our reporting relationship has shifted from the Department of Human Service Programs to the Equity and Inclusion Department
- This partnership supports the City in serving people as their whole selves
- In addition to our current portfolio of work, we look forward to working with the commissions and programs in Equity and Inclusion to help make all City programs, services, and departments more intersectional, accessible, and inclusive

Access and Inclusion are the Fabric of Cambridge

Accessibility and inclusion are ongoing and essential processes, and they must be prioritized continually. Cambridge recognizes that disability issues touch every City program and aspect of City life. CCPD works across City departments to acknowledge that the needs of people with disabilities are not “special”, but rather necessary to how the City functions.

Contact Information

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